

Online Notarization API — Proof vs. BlueNotary

Evaluating the two providers for an in-platform Remote Online Notarization (RON) integration · July 2026

THE ONE THING TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

Both providers let us run **everything on our own platform through their API** — preparing the document, inviting the signer, tracking status, and receiving the finished, sealed notarization back automatically. The **only** part that cannot live fully inside our own screen is the ~5-minute live video meeting with the notary: New York law requires the notary/provider to control and retain that audio-video recording, so it runs on the provider's hosted session. The realistic goal isn't "no hand-off" — it's a **branded hand-off so smooth the user barely notices**: they click "Notarize now," do the short video, and land right back on our site with the document already filed. This kills the download → find-a-notary → re-upload chase entirely.

AT A GLANCE

● Proof

formerly Notarize · market leader

API	Most mature. Business API, Webhooks v2 (signed), sandbox to test against.
BRANDING	Co-branded hosted page (our logo + colors) then auto-redirect back to us.
NOTARIES	Large 24/7 on-demand network; NY e-notaries.
API PLAN	Premium (annual contract, quote on request) — Pro tier has no API.
BEST FOR	Reliability, compliance record, fastest & safest to build against.

● BlueNotary

challenger · white-label focused

API	Solid. v2 REST, create-session, webhooks (set up via support), fetch signed doc.
BRANDING	True white-label — our logo, colors & our own domain ; feels entirely ours.
NOTARIES	20k+ on-demand notaries, KBA/biometrics, all 50 states + NY.
API PLAN	Enterprise (contact sales) for API + white-label; pricing not public.
BEST FOR	Strongest "looks like us" branding and lower per-seal cost.

CAPABILITY COMPARISON — FROM THE API STANDPOINT

DIMENSION	PROOF (NOTARIZE)	BLUENOTARY
Stays on our platform	MOSTLY All data/flow via API; signer uses a co-branded Proof page for the video, then redirects back to us.	MOSTLY All data/flow via API; signer uses a fully white-labeled page on our own domain, then returns to us.
True embedded iframe	NO Hosted session + redirect back (compliance-driven).	NO Hosted session (white-labeled) — no widget/iframe.
Branding depth	Logo, colors, text on a Proof-hosted page. Removing Proof's name entirely = Enterprise.	Logo, company name, colors, custom domain & branded emails included in white-label.
Create transaction / session	API POST /transactions with signer + PDF + notarization.	API Create Session + Add Document (base64); returns per-signer URLs.
Completion notice	Webhooks v2 HMAC-SHA256 signed events (transaction.released).	Webhooks Session events; configured with their team.
Retrieve sealed doc + evidence	Pre-signed links to sealed PDF + audit trail + notarial certificate.	Get Signed Document endpoint returns notarized file + metadata.
Sandbox / test mode	YES Test notary sessions + sample docs — build before going live.	LIMITED Test keys; webhook setup is support-assisted.
NY RON compliance	NY e-notaries; 10-yr AV retention handled by Proof.	NY supported; KBA/biometrics; 10-yr recording storage included.
Maturity / risk	Market leader, deep docs, most battle-tested API.	Smaller vendor; capable API but more "talk to sales/support" to wire up.

WHAT IT COSTS

Proof (Notarize)		BlueNotary	
PER NOTARIZATION		PER NOTARIZATION	
In-house notary (1 seal)	\$25	On-demand (1 stamp)	\$25
Via "Notarize Network"	\$10	Business Pro rate	\$10
Additional seal	\$10	Additional stamp	\$8
Additional signer	\$5	Additional signer	\$5
PLATFORM		PLATFORM	
API + co-branding	Premium (annual)	Business Pro	\$37/seat/mo
Pro tier (no API)	\$0/mo, pay-per-use	API + white-label	Enterprise (quote)

Per-seal figures are published rates; API/white-label tier pricing (Proof Premium, BlueNotary Enterprise) is quote-only — get both in writing before deciding. Either provider lets us choose whether **we** pay per seal (fold into our fee) or the signer pays at the end.

RECOMMENDATION FOR OUR GOAL

GIVEN WE WANT IT TO FEEL LIKE IT ALL HAPPENS ON OUR PLATFORM

Neither can fully embed the video meeting — that's an industry-wide compliance reality, not a product gap. The decision is really **which branded hand-off feels most like ours, at what cost and build-risk**.

BlueNotary wins the "stay on our system" feel — full white-label on **our own domain** + lowest cost — but is a smaller vendor with a hands-on API setup. **Proof** wins on reliability, compliance record, and the cleanest signed-webhook API + sandbox (fastest, safest to build) — at the cost of a co-branded page and a Premium annual contract.

Suggested move: get written API-tier quotes from both, then build against **Proof's sandbox** first — our adapter is provider-agnostic, so we can switch to **BlueNotary** if its white-label and price win.